

THE GREAT ESCAPES

The best weekend getaways India has to offer

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TOP 5 ADVENTURE DESTINATIONS NEAR BENGALURU

ANTHARGANGE (ANTARA GANGE)

Approximately 65 km from Bengaluru, situated near Kolar village, are the Shathashrunga mountains. Amongst these, the 5,616 ft Anthargange or Antara Gange is inarguably the most popular. With the Kashi Vishweshwara Temple at its top, the mountain is frequently visited by devout pilgrims, but adventure enthusiasts have now also discovered a forested trail behind the temple. The path is lined with caves that are a treat to crawl through, especially at night. Do not forget your torch!

NANDI HILLS

At a distance of just 60km, Nandi Hills seems only a stone's throw away from Bengaluru. At 4,851 ft above sea level, it is a great place to paraglide from. The ancient hill fortress also boasts of several trekking trails, not to mention the 1,175 steps you need to climb to reach its top. Tipu Sultan's summer retreat sits here, where the Tiger of Mysore escaped gruelling heat and battle. Tipu's Drop, a 600-metre-high cliff face, is a staggering sight. This is the precipice from where prisoners were hurled and executed. Not for the faint-hearted.

KUNTI BETTA

Named after the Mahabharata's Kunti, Kunti Betta is the name given to two rocky hills in Pandavpura (Mandya district), 125 km outside Bengaluru. If local lore is to believed, this is where the Pandavas stayed during their 14-year exile. The cave at the base of the two hills is said to have been their home, and the giant footprint-like rock formations are said to be the marks that the weight of Bhima's feet left behind. If swimming and kayaking are what you are after, the Thonnur Lake is only 10 km away.